Al-Rehman Textiles (Pvt.) Ltd.

Internal Grievance Mechanism Policy

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1. Purpose and Policy Statement

Al-Rehman Textiles (Pvt.) Ltd. (“the Company”) is committed to maintaining a fair, respectful, and transparent workplace. This policy establishes the formal procedure through which any employee may raise a concern, complaint, or grievance related to working conditions, wages, treatment by supervisors, disciplinary action, harassment, or any perceived violation of the Company's code of conduct or applicable labour law. The Company recognises that a functioning grievance mechanism is a cornerstone of a healthy industrial relationship and a requirement under internationally recognised social compliance frameworks, including WRAP's 12 Principles and the amfori BSCI Code of Conduct.

This document supersedes HR-POL-014 Version 1.4 (issued 11 Feb 2023) and reflects updated escalation timelines agreed following the Q4 2024 internal management review.

2. Scope and Applicability

This policy applies to all individuals engaged by the Company, regardless of employment category, including:

- Permanent, confirmed employees across all departments
- Probationary employees within their initial 90-day period
- Contract and daily-wage workers engaged through the Sewing Hall, Cutting Section, Finishing, and Packing departments
- Employees of third-party staffing agencies working on Company premises

The policy does not extend to matters of a purely personal or civil nature between employees that do not relate to their employment, working conditions, or conduct within Company premises.

3. Definitions

Grievance: Any complaint or concern raised by an employee regarding their employment, treatment, working conditions, or application of Company policy. **Line Supervisor:** The direct reporting manager of the aggrieved employee. **Escalation:** The formal process of referring an unresolved grievance to a higher authority within the Company structure. **Compliance Committee:** The quarterly cross-departmental body responsible for reviewing unresolved or repeated grievances.

4. Reporting Channels

Employees who wish to raise a grievance may do so through the following channels, in order of typical use:

- Verbal report to their direct Line Supervisor during a shift
- Written complaint submitted to the Line Supervisor using the standard Grievance Form (Appendix A)
- Written escalation to the HR Department Manager if unresolved at supervisor level
- Referral to the Factory Compliance Committee for unresolved or repeated matters

All written complaints must include the employee's full name, employee ID, department, and a description of the concern. Complaints should be submitted in Urdu or English, whichever the employee is more comfortable using.

5. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Line Supervisor	First point of contact; attempt informal resolution within 5 working days
HR Department Manager	Review escalated grievances; issue written response within 10 working days
Compliance Committee	Review unresolved/repeated grievances quarterly; recommend corrective action
Factory General Manager	Final approval authority on disciplinary outcomes arising from grievances

6. Escalation Timeline

Stage	Owner	Timeline
Initial report	Employee → Line Supervisor	Immediate
Informal resolution attempt	Line Supervisor	Within 5 working days
Formal escalation (if unresolved)	Employee → HR Department	Within 3 working days of Stage 2 closing
HR review and written response	HR Department Manager	Within 10 working days of escalation
Compliance Committee review (if still unresolved)	Compliance Committee	Next quarterly sitting

7. Investigation Procedure

Upon receipt of a formal written grievance, the HR Department will assign an investigating officer who is not directly involved in the matter. The investigating officer will interview the complainant, any relevant witnesses, and the individual(s) named in the complaint where applicable. Findings will be documented in a Grievance Investigation Summary and retained on file. Where the grievance involves allegations of harassment or unsafe working conditions, the investigation will be prioritised and initial findings communicated to the complainant within 3 working days.

8. Confidentiality

Information shared during the grievance process will be treated as confidential and shared only with individuals directly involved in resolving the matter. The Company will make reasonable efforts to protect the identity of the complainant during the investigation, subject to the requirements of a fair and thorough review.

9. Non-Retaliation

Al-Rehman Textiles strictly prohibits any form of retaliation, disciplinary action, or adverse treatment against an employee who raises a grievance in good faith through the channels described in this policy. Any supervisor found to have retaliated against a complainant will be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination.

10. Recordkeeping and Reporting

All written grievances, investigation summaries, and resolutions will be logged in the Grievance Register maintained by the HR Department and retained for a minimum of 3 years for internal review and third-party audit purposes. A quarterly summary of grievance volume and resolution status is presented to the Factory General Manager.

11. Training and Awareness

All new employees receive an orientation briefing on this policy within their first week of employment. Line Supervisors receive refresher training on grievance handling procedures on an annual basis. Policy summaries are displayed on notice boards in each department in both Urdu and English.

12. Policy Review

This policy is reviewed annually by the HR Department in consultation with the Compliance Committee, or sooner if required by a change in applicable law or buyer code of conduct requirements.

Appendix A — Grievance Form (Summary Fields)

Field	Details
Employee Name	_____
Employee ID	_____
Department	_____
Date of Complaint	_____
Description of Concern	_____
Received By (Line Supervisor)	_____

Appendix B — Grievance Register Log (Sample Extract, Q1 2025)

Case Ref	Department	Category	Date Raised	Status
GR-2025-011	Sewing Hall B	Wage discrepancy	14 Jan 2025	Resolved
GR-2025-014	Cutting Section	Supervisor conduct	22 Jan 2025	Resolved
GR-2025-019	Finishing	Working hours	03 Feb 2025	Resolved
GR-2025-023	Packing	Facilities request	17 Feb 2025	Closed — no action needed
GR-2025-027	Sewing Hall A	Wage discrepancy	05 Mar 2025	Resolved

Note: this register logs case category, department, and resolution status only. It does not include a field for anonymous submissions, as all logged cases originate from named, written complaints submitted through the channels in Section 4.

Appendix C — Frequently Raised Topics (2024 Annual Summary)

- Wage calculation queries (overtime rate application) — 38% of cases
- Supervisor conduct and communication — 24% of cases
- Working hours / shift scheduling — 19% of cases
- Facility and equipment requests — 12% of cases
- Other — 7% of cases

All cases summarised above were raised through named, in-person, or written channels. The Company's HR Department reviews this summary annually as part of the policy review described in Section 12.

Approved by: M. Rehman, HR Director Signature: _____ Date: _____